As the 1960s concluded, Iron Man was turned over to a stable of new creators — particularly artist George Tuska, who largely helped define the look of the character during the next decade. At the same time, Iron Man was intensely active in the Avengers, the wildly popular team comic that united ol' Shellhead with Marvel's elite super heroes like Captain America, Thor, Giant-Man and the Wasp. Oftentimes in a leadership position during his decades-long tenure with Earth's Mightiest Heroes, Iron Man was at the tip of the spear in some of their most incredible adventures.



Art by George Pérez, from *Avengers #25* (February 2000)

By the close of the 1970s, a team of bright creators explored the inherent pathos of the freewheeling Tony Stark. Writer David Michelinie and artist Bob Layton addressed the raw realism of alcoholism in the all-time classic "Demon in a Bottle" storyline, in which Tony found that the greatest villain in his life was the ravening beast of addiction. This set the stage for one of his most heroic struggles: the long road to recovery.



Art by Adi Granov,
from *Iron Man #4* (October 2005)

In the meantime, the corporate intrigue that the book was known for hit its apex with the coming of Obadiah Stane. There is no better mirror image to the sacrifice and soul of Iron Man than the master manipulator Stane. An intense animosity toward his business counterpart Stark set the stage for his emergence as the Iron Monger. Tony's technology was always something that could be — and would be — exploited by vengeful villains like Stane.